

NORTHSTAR OUTFITTERS

Returns & Exchanges Policy - Legacy

Historical 14-day return policy retained for knowledge-governance demonstration

CUSTOMER SAFE

Version	1.9 (Legacy)
Document owner	Customer Policy & Trust
Last updated	10 February 2026
Purpose	Legacy policy artifact intentionally retained to demonstrate DRAFT/READY lifecycle and conflict detection. Do not publish except during the explicit conflict demo.

Demo environment only. Northstar Outfitters, its customers, products, prices, orders, and commercial terms are fictional and created for SupportOps demonstrations.

Document Control

Audience	Historical customer-support reference
Scope	Legacy return window, exchanges, item condition, and refund timing
Authority	LEGACY. Superseded by Returns, Exchanges & Refund Policy v5.0. Keep DRAFT or READY unless intentionally testing conflicting published knowledge.
Review cycle	No regular review - legacy artifact
Change control	Material changes require owner review and publication before becoming authoritative knowledge.
Knowledge governance Only documents marked PUBLISHED in SupportOps are authoritative for customer-facing answers. Current Shopify catalog, variant, price, availability, cart, and authenticated order state should be obtained from the approved Shopify MCP capability rather than inferred from static documentation.	

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Legacy document

This document is intentionally outdated. The current policy allows 30 days; this legacy version states 14 days. In normal demo state it must not be PUBLISHED.

1. Legacy Status

This policy was used during an earlier Northstar demo period and has been superseded. It remains available to show why SupportOps publication state and source authority matter.

2. Return Window

Under this legacy policy, eligible change-of-mind returns were required within 14 calendar days of delivery.

Intentionally conflicting value

Current Returns, Exchanges & Refund Policy v5.0 uses a 30-day standard return window. If both documents are PUBLISHED, a customer-facing agent must not silently choose one. It should identify conflicting authoritative knowledge and escalate.

3. Condition Requirements

- Unworn/unused beyond reasonable try-on.
- Original tags attached where provided.
- Original footwear box/packaging returned where practical.
- No customer-caused damage, washing, or alteration.

4. Footwear

Footwear could be tried indoors on a clean surface. Visible outdoor wear could make change-of-mind returns ineligible.

5. Exchanges

Eligible items could be exchanged within the legacy 14-day window when the replacement variant was available.

6. Return Shipping

Change-of-mind return shipping was customer-paid. Merchant-error returns such as wrong or damaged items were handled separately.

7. Refunds

Approved refunds were returned to the original payment method after inspection. Financial-institution posting time varied.

8. Final Sale

Final-sale items were not eligible for change-of-mind returns, while wrong/damaged item remedies remained available.

9. FAQ

Q. How long do I have to return an item?

A. This legacy document says 14 days, but it is superseded and must not be used for current customer decisions.

Q. Why keep this file?

A. To test document lifecycle, retrieval authority, and conflict escalation.

Q. What should its SupportOps status be?

A. DRAFT or READY during normal demos; PUBLISHED only during the intentional conflict scenario.

10. Deprecation Note

Superseded by Returns, Exchanges & Refund Policy v5.0 dated 14 September 2026. Recommended normal SupportOps state: READY. After any conflicting-knowledge demo, revert this document from PUBLISHED to READY/DRAFT.

Appendix A - Historical Handling Notes

Topic	Legacy guidance
Late request	Manual review could be requested but was uncommon.
Wrong item	Merchant-funded correction, outside change-of-mind rules.
Damaged item	Evidence requested where practical; replacement/refund considered.
Gift order	Verification required; purchaser payment details protected.
Exchange stock	Replacement depended on live availability.

Appendix B - Historical Change Log

Version	Date	Change
1.9	10 Feb 2026	Clarified wrong-item treatment.
1.8	05 Jan 2026	Updated exchange availability wording.
1.5	12 Nov 2025	Added final-sale section.

Appendix C - Legacy Customer Examples

Historical customer request	Legacy answer at the time
Delivered 10 days ago, unworn shoe	Within legacy 14-day return window
Delivered 20 days ago, change of mind	Outside legacy standard return window
Wrong size shipped by merchant	Merchant-error correction; legacy time window not used to deny
Final sale but damaged on arrival	Damage remedy considered despite final-sale change-of-mind restriction

Appendix D - Why This Document Is Dangerous if Published

- Its 14-day return window conflicts directly with current 30-day policy.
- Semantic retrieval may score the legacy text highly because the wording closely matches return questions.
- A model could answer confidently with the wrong policy if publication state is ignored.
- Historical tickets may also cite the 14-day rule, increasing the risk of stale consensus.
- Therefore source status and authority must be enforced before retrieval/generation.

Appendix E - Conflict Demo Procedure

1. Keep current Returns, Exchanges & Refund Policy v5.0 PUBLISHED.
2. Keep this legacy policy READY during normal operation.
3. Ask: "How many days do I have to return an unworn item?" Verify answer is 30 days.
4. Temporarily publish this legacy policy.
5. Ask the same question. Expected behavior: SupportOps detects conflicting authoritative customer-safe sources and avoids choosing 14 or 30 silently.
6. Escalate or state that published information is inconsistent.
7. Return this document to READY after the demo.

Appendix F - Legacy-to-Current Mapping

Topic	Legacy	Current
Standard return window	14 days	30 days
Indoor footwear try-on	Allowed	Allowed
Wrong item	Merchant-error exception	Merchant-error exception
Change-of-mind return shipping	Customer normally pays	Customer normally pays
Final sale	No change-of-mind return	No change-of-mind return; wrong/damaged remedies preserved

Appendix G - Retrieval Test Questions

Question	Normal state expected result	Conflict-demo result
How many days do I have to return an unworn item?	30 days from current v5.0 policy	Conflict detected if legacy is also PUBLISHED
Can I return a wrong item after 20 days?	Wrong-item merchant-error rules; do not reduce to change-of-mind window	Same substantive handling; conflict is about standard window
Is final sale always non-returnable?	No change-of-mind return; wrong/damaged remedies preserved	Both docs generally agree